

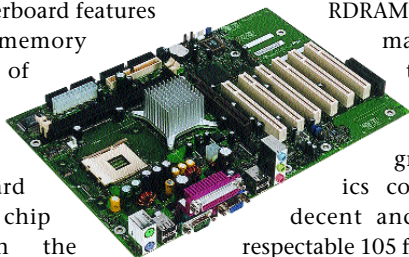
Intel D845GBV motherboard

845 ways to P4 integration

The Intel D845GBV motherboard is based on Intel's 845G chipset, which supports Intel processors based on the Socket 478 interface. The motherboard features a DDR memory interface of speeds up to 266 MHz, an onboard sound chip based on the Analog Devices AD1981A chipset and an onboard video chip based on Intel's Extreme graphics controller. It also integrates a network adapter. This makes it an ideal package for those with a limited budget, but who are still in need of a feature-rich solution. This board has one AGP, six PCI and one CNR slots, along with two DIMM sockets. It also supports a USB 2.0 port and 2 GB of DDR memory.

We tested this motherboard with a 2.53 GHz processor.

Price: Rs 8,120
Contact: Nebula Technologies
Phone: 022-6730567
E-mail: pradip@nebulatech.com
Web site: www.intel.com



It scored an impressive 63.2 in the Business Winstone 2001 test. In the Content Creation 2001, it achieved 89.3, almost matching the RDRAM-powered test machine using the same processor. The integrated graphics core is pretty decent and it scores a respectable 105 fps in the normal resolution in *Quake III Arena*.

The board is an excellent buy if you are looking for an ultra fast DDR solution and don't intend to buy a graphics card but want room for future upgradability.

SPECIFICATIONS

i845G chipset, support for Socket 478-class processors like Celeron and Pentium 4, 266 MHz DDR SDRAM memory interface, integrated graphics and audio

Intel D845GBV	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

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Microsoft Project 2002

Manage your projects to perfection

Microsoft Project is the world's leading project management program and this new release brings more intuitive tools and built-in project management assistance. It includes a new step-by-step interactive project guide that helps you set up a new project, manage tasks and resources, track schedules and report project information.

It has improved grouping

and information displays within the network diagram (which shows you all the tasks in a graphical manner) and new smart tags that alert you to alternative scheduling choices when you make changes to your project plans. You can now import task lists from Microsoft Outlook or save multiple baseline estimates for any project. This software will be appreciated by everyone, from small companies to large



organisations that work on tight deadlines and have enormous number of tasks spanning over a number of years.

Price: Rs 50,000
Contact: Kemptron Systems
Phone no: 011-6286258
Fax no: 011-6286260
E-mail: kemptron@del3.vsnl.net.in
Web site: www.microsoft.com/products

Sun StarOffice 6.0

New star on the horizon

Sun's office suite comes Spacked with all the standard office productivity tools—word processor, spreadsheet, presentation, drawing, formula-design and HTML-editing applications. This version opens and saves Microsoft Word, Excel, and PowerPoint



files, and the disk requirements are modest. Installing it is easy and automated and can take up to 230 MB. In addition, it installs several fonts, which will replace the existing ones in Windows, but the installation process gives you the option of retaining your original fonts.

It offers over 130 templates, backgrounds, and formats, from business letters to full-blown thesis formats. When editing large documents, the Master Document lets you create styles for multiple files. The Spreadsheet software is fairly competent

Price: \$75.60 (approx Rs 3,750)
E-mail: csr-customer-service@sun.com
Web site: www.sun.com

SPECIFICATIONS

Minimum System Requirements: Windows 98/98 SE/NT 4.0 with SP6/Me/2000, 234 MB hard disk space, 112 MB RAM Pentium 133 MHz processor, mouse or compatible device, CD-ROM drive, SVGA monitor

Microsoft Project 2002	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

B+

too. When we imported our comparison test tables and formulae-filled Excel files, conversion was almost perfect. Note that these files were created in Microsoft Office 2000/2002; results could vary with older versions.

We also imported several large PowerPoint files with generally good results, though we noted some errors in the reproduction of text formatting. As with Microsoft PowerPoint, you have control over the speed and timing of shows, you can select from a wide range of transitions, and there's a thumbnail page for an overall view. All-in-all, StarOffice 6.0 is an impressive package. It contains features you use every day and some you'll never touch, all at a reasonable price. However, the full download version of StarOffice 6.0 can only be used for a single operating system.

SPECIFICATIONS

Minimum System Requirements: Windows 95/98/ME/NT/2000/XP, Pentium/Athlon processor, 64 MB RAM, 250 MB hard disk space, 800x600 or higher-resolution graphics card with 256 colours

Sun StarOffice 6.0	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

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